

But with data getting increasingly heavier, the limitations of the technology have started showing. High-definition movies and content are quite common these days, which result in large file sizes. Streaming this footage from one device to another is not possible with the current Bluetooth 2.0 standard that affords maximum transfer speeds of 2 Mbps.



Bluetooth 3.0 is 'born to go fast'

The ideal alternative, of course, was Wi-Fi/WLAN and its broader 802.11 standard, which allows for speeds of up to 100 Mbps. But the strain of Wi-Fi connections on mobile batteries is too high, even when you have small transfers going on, to make it the default connectivity technology.

In April, the Bluetooth Special Interest Group (SIG) released an upgraded version of its standard, the Bluetooth 3.0. Quoting SIG executive director Michael Foley, who will have to live with these words for the rest of his life: "Like Ricky Bobby in Talladega Nights, this latest version was 'born to go fast'."

While the reference to that abysmal Will Ferrell movie deducts a lot of style points, he was quite spot-on with the basic message. Bluetooth 3.0 integrates the 802.11 standard, turning the wireless connectivity game on its head.

Now, when you need to transfer a small file, Bluetooth will still use its current radio uplink to send the data across, thus saving battery life. But when the technology detects that you are looking to transfer much larger packets of data, it automatically switches to the 802.11 protocol, boosting speeds up to 24 Mbps.

Another aspect of the technology is that it can make